

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Rivers run wild!



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about geography, climate and environmental problems.
- I can speculate about past events.
- I can report facts about events or actions.

Ask your partner:

- What happens during a flood? Explain in as much detail as possible.
- How could you prepare for a flood?

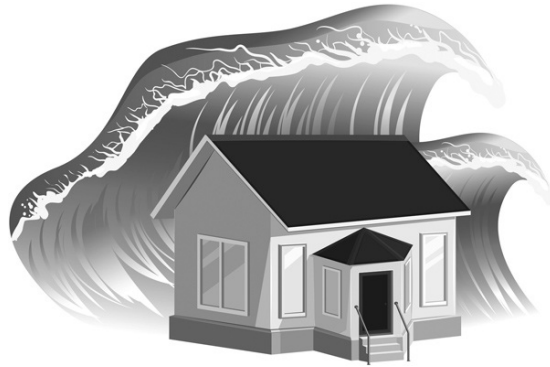




Let's Explore!

Hurricane Katrina* caused serious floods.

* "Hurricane Katrina" was the largest hurricane to hit the United States. It was also the costliest.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Water is both a source of life and a powerful force. Ever since the story of Noah, who built a famous ark for the great flood, people have been struggling to control the world's waterways and prevent their flooding. Major rivers which bring the gifts of precious water and fertile soil to the people who live along their banks also bring disaster. What might have happened if people had known how to control water more efficiently?

It's hard to say. Throughout human history, people have struggled to control the raging waters of major waterways but never with complete success. The Chinese who live along the Yellow River have had more than two thousand years of trying to control the watery, and at times, angry giant.

In the third century BC an engineer named Wu, who later became the Emperor of China, designed and executed a successful plan to drain the mighty Yellow River, causing the water level to drop. Despite Wu's success, the Yellow River has flooded more than one thousand times in the last two thousand years and caused the deaths of over seven million people in the last hundred years alone. How many more people might have died if Wu had not been able to drain the river?

The present Chinese government, which continues to struggle against the three thousand miles of the Yellow River, is presently at work constructing a major dam to further control this fluid dragon.

In the U.S. there are problems with flooding as well, as seen when Hurricane Katrina hit land. What might have happened if New Orleans had been more prepared for the flooding, which caused 108 billion dollars in damage and killed thousands? Rising flood waters may not have caused businesses to close, homes to be destroyed or families to be evacuated. A state of emergency may not have been declared. The levees, which were supposed to keep the water out, failed. New Orleans, which is well below sea level and sinking, is expecting more flooding in the future. The levees, which can erode over time, are being raised.

Nevertheless, will they hold when the water rises again?





Let's Practice!

Water is a great power!

Instructions: Write the number of each of the sentences under their corresponding category.

Sentences with relative clauses that give additional information about the topic.

Sentences with relative clauses that give essential information about the topic.

1. The Chinese government, which continues to struggle against the three thousand miles of the Yellow River, is presently at work constructing a major dam.
2. Ever since the story of Noah, who built a famous ark for the great flood, people have been struggling.
3. An engineer named Wu, who later became the Emperor of China, designed and executed a successful plan.
4. The people who live along river banks had to prepare themselves for disaster.
5. The Chinese who live along the Yellow River have had more than two thousand years of trying to control it.
6. Major rivers which bring the gifts of precious water and fertile soil also bring disaster.



Let's Practice!

Structures to control water are important for safety.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Cross out the incorrect words. Rewrite the sentences correctly. Use capital letters where necessary.

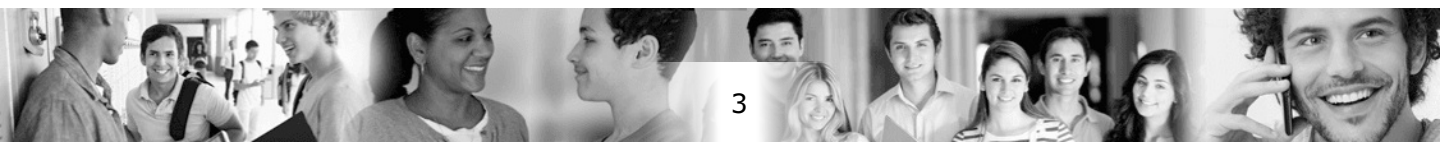
What might have happen if people had known how to control water more efficiently?

How many more people may has died if Wu had not been able to drain the river?

What may had happened if New Orleans had been more prepared for the flooding?

Rising flood waters may not have cause businesses to close.

A state of emergency might not had been declared.





Extension Activity

Watch a video about surviving a flash flood in your car.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and watch a video on how to survive a flash flood when you are in a car.
- Take notes on new vocabulary and the tips you learn.
- Look up any new words in the dictionary.
- Tell a friend what you learned.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch and listen to a video about climate problems.

☐ ☐

I write down the tips of how to survive and I write down new vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I look up the definitions of the new words.

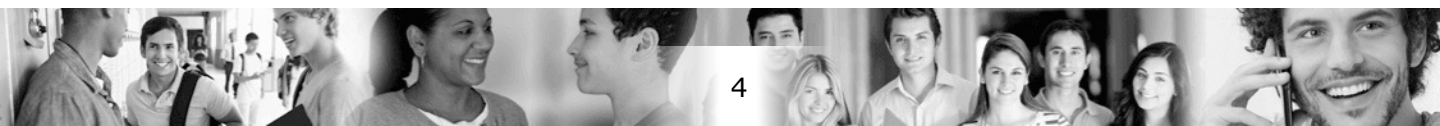
☐ ☐

I tell a friend what I have learned.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- ark** (noun): ship
e.g. Ever since the story of Noah, who built a famous ark for the great flood, people have been struggling to control the world's waterways and prevent their flooding.
- to struggle** (verb): to make a great effort in order to overcome a difficulty
e.g. Ever since the story of Noah, who built a famous ark for the great flood, people have been struggling to control the world's waterways and prevent their flooding.
- raging** (adjective): very strong or violent
e.g. Throughout human history, people have struggled to control the raging waters of major waterways but never with complete success.
- to declare** (verb): to publicly announce
e.g. A state of emergency may not have been declared.
- to evacuate** (verb): to move people somewhere safe
e.g. Rising flood waters may not have caused businesses to close, homes to be destroyed or families to be evacuated.
- dam** (noun): wall built across a river to stop its flow
e.g. The present Chinese government, which continues to struggle against the three thousand miles of the Yellow River, is presently at work constructing a major dam to further control this fluid dragon.
- to drain** (verb): to allow or cause liquid to flow away
e.g. In the third century BC an engineer named Wu, who later became the Emperor of China, designed and executed a successful plan to drain the mighty Yellow River.
- sinking** (adjective): going below surface because of flooding
e.g. New Orleans, which is well below sea level and sinking, is expecting more flooding in the future.
- levee** (noun): wall made of soil to stop a river from overflowing
e.g. The levees, which can erode over time, are being raised.





Learning Points

May Have and Might Have

May Have and *Might Have* can be used to speculate about the past.

You can use "May Have" and "Might Have" to express past uncertainty.

For example:

*I suppose I **may have** been a bit tough on her.*

You can use "Might Have" to refer to a past possibility which did not occur.

For example:

*My goodness, you **might have** lost everything!*

You can use both in negative statements to express uncertainty.

For example:

*She **might not have** received my text.*

"Might Have" is also used to express annoyance, especially at someone's failure to say or do something.

For example:

*You **might have** told me that your parents were visiting!*

Finally, "Might Have" is used idiomatically with "Known" to express something that should have been obvious or expected.

For example:

*I **might have known** she would try to pull something. She's always been a prankster.*

Look at these examples from the text:

Examples:

- *What **might have** happened if people had known how to control water more efficiently?*
- *A state of emergency **may not have** been declared.*
- *Rising flood waters **may not have** caused businesses to close.*





Learning Points

Relative Clauses: Defining vs. Non-Defining

You use relative clauses to give extra information about someone or something. There are two types of relative clauses: "Defining" and "Non-Defining".

Defining Relative Clauses:

A "Defining Relative Clause" tells you which specific person or thing you are talking about.

For example:

*The **kid who delivers** the newspaper wanted a tip.*
*The **newspaper which the kid delivers** is called "The Times".*
*The **bike that he rides** is red.*

Non-Defining Relative Clauses:

A "Non-Defining Relative Clause" tells you extra information regarding the person or thing you are talking about. This information is usually not essential.

For example:

*The kid, **who went to the same school as my brother**, delivered the newspaper.*
*The newspaper, **which is printed in town**, is called "The Times".*

Note that the relative pronoun "that" is not used in Non-Defining Relative Clauses.

Look at these examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Major rivers which bring the gifts of precious water and fertile soil to the people who live along their banks also bring disaster.*
- *In the third century BC an engineer named Wu, who later became the Emperor of China, designed and executed a successful plan to drain the mighty Yellow River.*
- *New Orleans, which is well below sea level and sinking, is expecting more flooding in the future.*

